

UNITED NATIONS NATIONS UNIES
DEPARTMENT OF ECONOMIC AND SOCIAL AFFAIRS

ITALIAN FELLOWSHIPS PROGRAMME
FOR TECHNICAL COOPERATION
CAPACITY BUILDING AND HUMAN RESOURCES DEVELOPMENT
2025-2026

Fellowship Award Specification

**United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP)
Regional Office for Africa – Addis Ababa Liaison Office**

1. General Information

<u>Title:</u>	UN Fellow
<u>Orientation Workshop dates:</u>	May 2026 (tbc)
<u>Assignment in the field dates:</u>	May 2026 – May 2027 (tbc)
<u>Duty Station:</u>	Addis Ababa, Ethiopia
<u>Sector of assignment:</u>	Environment and Sustainable Development

2. Supervision

<u>Name of the Supervisor:</u>	Ms. Rose Mwebaza
<u>Title of the Supervisor:</u>	Director and Regional Representative
<u>Name of the Direct Supervisor</u>	Ms. Margaret Oduk
<u>Title of the Direct Supervisor:</u>	Head, UNEP- Addis Ababa Liaison Office- Ethiopia

3. Background information

Established in 1972, United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP) is the leading global environmental authority that sets the global environmental agenda, promotes the coherent implementation of the environmental dimension of sustainable development within the United Nations system and serves as an authoritative advocate for the global environment.

UNEP's mission is to provide leadership and encourage partnership in caring for the environment by inspiring, informing, and enabling nations and peoples to improve their quality of life without compromising that of future generations. Headquartered in Nairobi, Kenya, UNEP works through its

divisions as well as regional, liaison and out-posted offices and a growing network of collaborating centres of excellence.

UNEP Regional Office for Africa supports environmental governance institutions and processes and engages a broad range of partners that include governmental, non-governmental, academic, and private sector entities on multilateral environmental agreements and sustainability programmes and projects in response to national, sub-regional and regional needs and priorities. UNEP's support to countries, sub-regions and Africa is guided by reforms of the UN Development System including the UN Resident Coordinator and UN Country Team systems.

The UN Fellow will be under the overall supervision of the Head UNEP Addis Ababa Liaison Office to African Union Commission (AUC), UN Economic Commission for Africa (UNECA) and Representative to Ethiopia (AALO) and with guidance of the Regional Director for Africa Office. AALO's mission is to strategically engage with the African Union Commission, the United Nations Economic Commission for Africa and Ethiopia country. Specific objectives of the Office are as follows:

- Facilitate UN Environment's Programme delivery in Ethiopia through identification of new areas of cooperation with relevant partners which could enhance UN Environment's Program of Work and encourage sustainable development;
- Foster a strategic partnership with the Government of Ethiopia (e.g. through supporting development and implementation of the environment dimension of the UN Sustainable Development Cooperation Framework (UNSDCF) and other partners in the country including academic institutions, civil society organizations and youth;
- Develop linkages with the African Union Commission to strengthen the environmental dimension of pan-African initiatives in accordance with the United Nations 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development and the Africa Union Agenda 2063: The Africa We Want (e.g. through supporting the African Strategies on Biodiversity, Climate Change, Ocean Governance, Blue Economy, Circular Economy, Combatting Illegal Trade in Wild Fauna and Flora, promotion of renewable energy initiatives, environmental diplomacy, Sustainable Land Management etc);
- Strengthen cooperation with UN Economic Commission for Africa and other UN agencies, including the UN Liaison Team in Addis Ababa, through joint programming and thematic alignment.

4. Duties, responsibilities and output expectations:

Within the framework of the Fellowships Programme for Technical Cooperation Capacity Building and Human Resources Development, the candidate will perform the following duties:

- Provide support in fostering partnership with development partners, civil society organizations, private sector, as well as with UN agencies while contributing to resources mobilization efforts;
- Provide support on UNEP participation and engagement in United Nations Sustainable Development Cooperation Framework (UNSDCF) processes in Ethiopia, Eritrea and Djibouti through thematic working groups;
- Assist in developing an awareness raising strategy that will ensure the widespread application of environmental governance modalities through improving/enhancing governments' capacities to effectively enforce, implement and comply with Multilateral Environmental Agreements (MEAs);
- Carry out research on selected aspects of programmes, operations and other activities, including data collection, analysis and presentation of data on scientific, socio-economic and other information related to Environment and report findings through UNSDCF and other related processes, as appropriate;

- Assist in the drafting, as required, of project proposals for submission to donor agencies, in coordination with Africa Office, UNEP Divisions, and other partners as appropriate, on emerging environmental trends in Ethiopia;
- Assist in ensuring timely and coordinated participation, provision of inputs to Addis Ababa Liaison Office meetings, meetings organized by UNEP in collaboration with partners, as well as coordinated response by UNEP to requests, as appropriate;
- Assist in the preparation and finalization of various materials including briefing notes, outreach materials responding to memos and other correspondences, as well as the compilation of reports on UNEP's interventions in Ethiopia, as necessary;
- Perform other duties as may be assigned towards the successful implementation of the functions of the Office.

5. Qualifications and Experience

Education

An advanced university degree (Master's degree or equivalent) in Environmental Studies, Economics, Development studies, Social Sciences, or related fields is required.

Work experience

Twelve (12) months of experience of working in the context of environmental management, policy development or related areas is required. Knowledge in data analytics or related areas is an advantage.

Languages

English and French are the working languages of the United Nations Secretariat. For this position, fluency in English is required. Knowledge of French is desirable

Other skills

Knowledge of data analytics or related areas is an advantage.

Competencies

PROFESSIONALISM: Demonstrates professional competence and mastery of subject matter. Is conscientious and efficient in meeting commitments, observing deadlines and achieving results. Is motivated by professional rather than personal concerns. Shows persistence when faced with difficult problems or challenges. Remains calm in stressful situations

COMMUNICATION: Ability to express ideas clearly, concisely and persuasively, including ability to defend and explain difficult issues; Speaks and writes clearly and effectively. Listens to others, correctly interprets messages from others and responds appropriately. Asks questions to clarify and exhibits interest in having two-way communication. Demonstrates openness in sharing information and keeping people informed.

TEAMWORK: Ability to establish and maintain effective working relationships in a multi-cultural , multi-ethnic environment with sensitivity and respect for diversity; Ability to lead and gain assistance and cooperation of others in a team endeavor; Ability to work independently and to participate effectively in a team-based information sharing environment. Works collaboratively with colleagues to achieve organizational goals. Solicits input by genuinely valuing others' ideas and expertise; is willing to learn from others.

6. Learning Elements

At the end of the assignment the Fellow will be able to:

Understanding of UN Systems and Environmental Governance

- Gain a better understanding of the UN Country Team (UNCT) operations and the Common Country Analysis (CCA).
- Learn about UNEP's Medium-Term Strategy and Programme of Work.
- Understand the role of UNEP within the UN system and its environmental leadership.

Gain experience on Project and Programme Assessment

- Assessment and monitoring of the implementation of programmes and projects.
- Analysis of donor trends and evaluation of strategic partnership opportunities.

Learning on Report Writing and Communication in international settings.

- Draft/edit a variety of reports on UN policy issues and strategies.
- Conduct environmental advocacy and support communication and outreach activities.

7. Content and methodology of the supervision

Initial Briefing and Orientation

- Upon commencement of the assignment, the supervisor provides a comprehensive **briefing on office responsibilities**, organizational structure, key stakeholders, and ongoing programmes.
- A **work plan** is jointly developed, outlining specific tasks, deliverables, timelines, and learning objectives aligned with the assignment.

Regular Meetings with Supervisor

- **Weekly or bi-weekly check-ins** are scheduled to review progress, address challenges, and adjust priorities.
- These meetings serve as a platform for feedback, guidance, and strategic alignment with UNEP's goals and the host country's needs.

Reporting Procedures

- The candidate is expected to submit **monthly progress reports** summarizing activities, achievements, challenges, and lessons learned.
- **Quarterly reports** are prepared for broader dissemination, including contributions to UNEP's country presence documentation and donor updates.
- Ad hoc reports may be requested for specific events, missions, or stakeholder engagements.

Performance and Learning Reviews

- Mid-term and end-of-assignment reviews are conducted to assess performance against the work plan and learning objectives.
- These reviews include self-assessment, supervisor feedback, and recommendations for future development.

Mentorship and Support

- The supervisor provides ongoing **mentorship**, helping the officer navigate complex political and institutional environments.
- Opportunities for **peer learning** and collaboration with other UN staff are encouraged.

Documentation and Knowledge Sharing

- The candidate is expected to maintain organized records of activities, decisions, and correspondence.
- Contributions to internal knowledge platforms (e.g., intranet, shared drives) are part of the supervision framework to ensure institutional memory.

Feedback and Adaptation

- The supervision approach is adaptive, allowing for **real-time feedback** and course correction.
- Constructive feedback is provided in a supportive manner to foster professional growth and confidence.

8. Living conditions in the country

The Federal Democratic Republic of Ethiopia is a landlocked country located in the Horn of Africa region of East Africa. It shares borders with Eritrea to the north, Djibouti to the northeast, Somalia to the east, Kenya to the south, South Sudan to the west, and Sudan to the northwest. Ethiopia covers a land area of 1,104,300 square kilometres (426,400 sq mi). As of 2025, its population was about 128 million, making it the thirteenth-most populous country in the world, the second-most populous in Africa after Nigeria, and the most populous landlocked country on Earth. The national capital and largest city is Addis Ababa. It lies several kilometres west of the East African Rift that splits the country into the African and Somali tectonic plates. The population is estimated at about 5.5 million or so. It is located in the Ethiopian highlands at an altitude of 2,500-2,700 meters. The climate is sunny and temperate, but it can be very cold at night, with freezing temperature at times. It is therefore advisable to bring warm clothing and foresee using heaters and/or log fires when necessary.

Addis Ababa is the headquarters for the UN Economic Commission for Africa as well as the African Union (ex-OAU). Thus, there is a very large community of expatriates from all over the world. There are some 80 embassies/diplomatic missions.

Housing is most of the time readily available and the rents are, on average, reasonable. Most foodstuffs, beverages, household goods, furniture and clothing, mostly imported from the Middle/Far East, South Africa and Europe, or local brands, can be found, although they can be expensive. Meat, fish, fresh fruits and vegetables are cheap and abundantly available.

The basic infrastructures - roads, utilities, and telecommunications - are below standard, as are medical facilities, which are still largely inadequate, although a few private clinics and hospitals provide reasonably good routine care.

There are lots of tourist attractions to visit around the country, although the amenities are often poor to average. Several restaurants around the city serve local or international cuisine and there are numerous social and cultural events throughout the year organized by the international and local communities.

Sports facilities (fitness, tennis, swimming, riding, golf, etc.) exist in the major hotels or in different establishments around the city.